of four senior officials'.[34] The same pattern was repeated at the 1962 Beidaihe meeting. The Canadian professor Lorenz M. Lüthi argues that Mao then 'staged a brilliant comeback in daily policy making. He used this momentum to stamp his mark on Chinese foreign relations.'[35] This meant virulent condemnation of his new enemies, the 'Soviet revisionists', and getting ready for a war against India, although contingency plans for military action would have been discussed only among Mao's inner circle of trusted followers and behind closed doors and not during the actual conference. In other words, part of the plan was to sideline and marginalize what was left of the opposition to Mao within the Party and the state apparatus.[36] A major build-up of war materiel and an increase in the number of Chinese troops along the border could be noticed only a few days after the Beidaihe conference was concluded on 27 August.[37]

In November, as war was raging in the Himalayas, an article in the *Zhōngguó Qīngnián Bào* (*China Youth Daily*, the official newspaper of the Communist Youth League of China), stated that, 'the past ten years of practice in socialist construction … have proven the unqualified correctness of Mao Tse-tung [Zedong]'.[38] Even more striking was an article in the 8 January 1963 issue of the newspaper. Mao was 'at all times standing higher and seeing farther than anyone else…the way Chairman Mao Zedong looks at problems must be like standing on top of a skyscraper looking down on the streets and roads below. Each path, turn and curve comes into his views. How can it be possible for him to lose direction?'[39]

At the same time, the anti-Soviet rhetoric reached a crescendo. According to a declassified CIA document,

> In late September and early October [1962] Chinese Communist spokesmen were asserting that the CPSU [the Communist Party of the Soviet Union] had "given up" leadership of the world revolution … [and] that this leadership had passed by default from Moscow and Khrushchev to Peiping [Beijing] and Mao Tse-tung [Zedong], and that although seemingly isolated, Communist China was now supported by a majority of people in the socialist camp and would pursue thereafter "uncompromising" struggle with the USSR.[40]

The CIA document goes on to refer to an editorial in the *People's Daily* of 15 November, which stated that Beijing claimed 'supreme doctrinal authority within the international Communist movement'[41]. The editorial concluded with a call for 'all Marxist-Leninists to resolutely carry on the